

BABYLON ORCHESTRA // PROJECTS 2024-25



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Availability upon request

ECHOES OF THE MEDITERRANEAN

with Merve Akyildiz (TUR) // Momo Djender (ALG/FRA) //
Stelina Apotolopoulou (GRC) // Basma Jabr (SYR/AUT)

“Echoes of Mediterranean” is a project by Babylon ORCHESTRA which presents love songs, ballads, personal stories and newly written vocal pieces for this occasion based on texts by authors who lived in the countries around the Mediterranean or have related to it in various ways during their lives. Hence, the listener encounters a performance taking him through the history of the Mediterranean cultures. Three singers from Greece, Syria and Turkey and 7 musicians from various countries of the Middle East and Europe performing together as a mixed ensemble with traditional and modern instruments. By using combinations composed and improvised elements, acoustic and electric as well as electronic instruments we create a lively and dramatic, almost scenic performance showcasing the richness of this cultural heritage. Sephardic, Arabic, Turkish and Greek folk songs with new arrangements (like f.e. Smirneiko Minore from 1909 from Smyrna or Morena me liaman from Sephardic Jewish tradition in Spain) make the core of this concert program.

7-16 instrumentalists , 2-4 singers

TRAILER – Echoes of Mediterranean <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LheZ3k-eOUk>

SAID ALYASSARI (Syrian trad.) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0CCCS_QM-00

LULLABY (Basma Jabr) + IBRAHIM (Momo Djender) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r6_K_j9TGcQ

GHAZALE (Arab. - Turk.) – with Rebal Alkhodari https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9n9bH5pY_D8

RAIHA OUINE (Algerian) – with Momo Djender <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zH6u-zCVrtk>

BABYLON PLAYGROUND: WOOD AND BRASS – big band program

Programme example, can be adapted individually on request, with possible feature guests: Tarek Yamani (LBN), John Kameel Farah (CND/PTN), Mahan Mirarab (IRN)

The sound worlds of the Babylon Orchestra, whose musicians come from Syria, Russia, Germany and Iran, among other places, lie between the Middle East and Europe. Different musical traditions are combined in new compositions and improvisations that leave the European tonal system behind - the Babylon Orchestra literally plays "between familiar sounds". Through tunings from the Middle East, European instruments sound in an unusual way, instruments from there mix with European string instruments to form a transcultural jazz band, between Maqam and Balkan beats, microtonal scales and avant-garde folk.

- - John Kameel Farah (Canada/Palestine): Jinju dervish
- - Dance on Bayat (Syria): Milad Khawam
- - Mahan Mirarab (Iran): Mahir II
- - Layale Chaker (Lebanon/France): Frah el Donnyie
- - Mischa Tangian (Germany/Russia): Flying Sticks
- - Farhang Moshtagh (Iran): Chahargah (UA)
- - Improvisation
- - Mischa Tangian: Santoor Intermezzo
- - Maias Alyamani (Syria): Reborn
- - Tarek Yamani (Lebanon): Qumairah
- - John Farah (Canada/Palestine): Between Carthage and Rome

10 instrumentalists

LINKS – Videos:

BETWEEN CARTHAGE and ROME <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=C4hg7norXQo>

REBORN <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=53w8CncvxK8>

NEW BABYLONIA

with Kinan Azmeh (SYR) // Naghib Shanbehzadeh (IRN) // Layale Chaker (LBN)

With the world-known Syrian clarinetist Kinan Azmeh (NYC), Iranian virtuoso percussionist Naghib Shanbehzadeh (Paris) and Lebanese violinist Layale Chaker (NYC), the sextet of the Babylon ORCHESTRA strings explore the music from the countries of the ancient Babylonian Empire – today this area includes not only countries such as Iran and Iraq, but also Syria and as far as Lebanon or Armenia. Original compositions that take up traditional elements of these cultures in fresh modern form and improvisations between the musicians from Iran, Europe and Asia will give an impression of the current cultural diversity of the Near East through this special encounter.

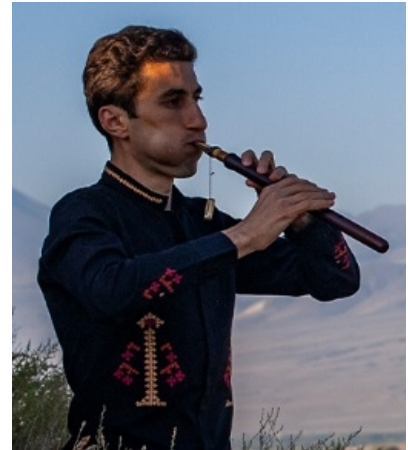
9 instrumentalists

LINKS – Videos:

TRIP TO GHOUTA – Chameleon Orchestra version <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NfTdiSwv4RU>



Kinan Azmeh – NEW BABYLONIA



Arsen Petrosyan - Armenia

ARMENIAN CONCERT – The forgotten

with soloist (Arsen Petrosyan - Armenia), Duduk

Die Vergessenen“ (the forgotten) is a journey to a fictional Armenia – rediscovering the ancient heritage of this Caucasian region with its neighbouring countries Iran, Georgia, Russia and Turkey. Coming from an Armenian and Russian family, Mischa Tangian was born in Moscow and visited Armenia in 2023 for the first time and hence imagined this program before his trip as the Armenia he heard from stories and from the Armenian dance music he listened to. Inviting world-class musician Arsen Petrosyan on Duduk the songs and dances from the region with its rhythms and melodies from medieval times up to contemporary and new songs by artists like Ara Dinkjian, Avetysian and alike this venture brings you to the faraway mountaineous region of Middle Asia.

(The program may be accompanied by visuals and animations.)

- - Khachatur Avetysian: Tagh gorani (from Avetysians Oratorium)
- - Mischa Tangian: The forgotten
- - Improvisation
- - Arsen Petrosian (Arr. M. Tangian): Javakhki Shoror
- - Ara Dinkjian, Arr. Moh. Nasser: Lullaby for the sun
- - KOMITAS - Arr. D. Bacikin: Medley - Three Komitas Songs
- - Qele, Erkinq, Kakavik
- - Mischa Tangian: Arabesca Romancesca
- - Sareri Hovin (trad. Armenian)
- - Trad. Armenian medieval Solo (Duduk / Drone)

8-10 instrumentalists

LINKS – Videos:

TRAILER Armenian concert - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p6XKcNG5nbl&t=44s>
 SARERI HOVIN MERNEM (animation) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0R_gty7I6m0
 THE FORGOTTEN - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WJNOLY7A6SE&t=56s>